



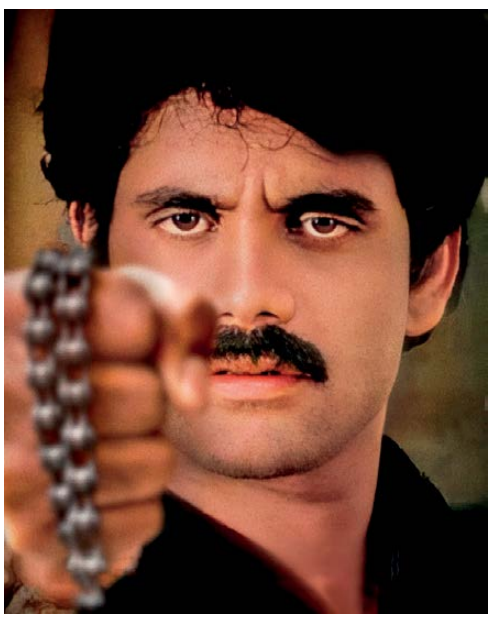
**BOLD & BEAUTIFUL** (Clockwise from top) Stills from Mani Ratnam's *Roja*, 1992; RK's *Ram Teri Ganga Maili*, 1985; and RGV's debut feature *Shiva*, 1989. Sushmita Sen and Aishwarya Rai, who would also knock on Bollywood's doors soon, got their entry pass—the beauty titles—in 1994




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and *Roja* (1992) the ones with most recall value—and RGV (*Shiva*, 1989) were influential enough to make the crossover to Hindi with definitive hits. Then there were industry veterans like Telugu's Singeetham Srinivasa Rao, whose *Pushpak* was a nod to the silent-era Hollywood films of the 1920s.

The auteurs soldiered on. Hindi had its last wave from the parallel stream that began in the '70s, with gems like *Trikal* (Shyam Benegal, 1985), *Mirch Masala* (Ketan Mehta, 1987), *Ek Doctor ki Maut* (Tapan Sinha, 1990). Those in Malayalam, Bengali, Kannada were in full flush.